



VOLCANOES

When you shake up a can of soda pop and open it, the contents shoot out with a great whoosh! Some volcanoes act a bit like this. With tremendous force, molten (melted) rock bursts through weak parts in the Earth's crust and is hurled high into the sky. This molten rock is called magma when still inside the Earth, and lava after it has erupted.

Volcanoes can be quiet and not erupt for a long time.

Hot springs are often found near volcanoes.



Nature's fireworks

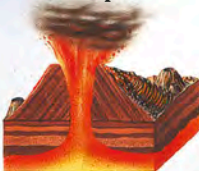
This volcano is putting on its own spectacular fireworks display. The explosions of red-hot lava and ash from the crater look like gigantic "Roman Candles."

The spotter's guide to volcano shapes



Spreading out

The lava from shallow shield volcanoes is runny, so it spreads out in a thin sheet.



Short and plump

Cinder cones are a bit bigger. They are made of ash, which is lava that has turned to dust.



Going up

Composite volcanoes have pointed cones. Their lava is thick and sticky.

